

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Manager and Product Owner for mission-critical technology.*

Positioning, 13 years owning backlogs and roadmaps in defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, and payments, across multi-stakeholder environments where scope decisions carry real consequence.

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Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Specialist, Product Management role at Space42.

My background fits this posting closely. I have 13 years of product ownership in environments where the backlog is not a wish list and sequencing decisions carry real operational consequence. At Rohde & Schwarz I owned the backlog and roadmap for the FCAS European programme, a multinational AI and data platform, managing 15 engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira. I pushed back on scope requests that would have destabilised a platform already serving production workloads, and I defended those calls to senior stakeholders across multiple organisations. Before that, at the Bundesagentur für Arbeit, I ran a national labour-market analytics platform as both Product Manager and Deputy IT Security Officer, which gave me direct exposure to security-conscious, structured environments where you cannot move fast and break things.

The posting describes a role with real authority over scope and sequencing, and the expectation that you will challenge or defer requests where required. That is how I have always worked. At CLINET Platforms I inherited a backlog a five-person team could not deliver, cut it to the top 10% of features against agreed success criteria, and user acceptance rose more than fivefold. At EMIL Group I restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams with their own leads, which stopped the senior engineer attrition that was eroding client trust. Both situations required making and defending decisions that not everyone in the room wanted to hear.

Your preference for experience in government, defence, aerospace, or other mission-critical environments is something I can meet directly rather than approximate. The FCAS programme and the Bundesdruckerei identity management platform for the Robert Koch Institute are both in that category. I also co-founded Qcrypt AG, an IT security company building quantum-secure encryption for enterprise and government buyers, I was Product Owner there for six years and later served as Chair of the board.

The AI-driven angle Space42 leads with is also where I work today. I use Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, and Lovable as daily tools for specification, prototyping, and edge-case analysis, and I have shipped agentic workflows in my own projects. I understand the difference between AI as a buzzword in a roadmap and AI as a shipping dependency in a live system.

I am open to relocating to Abu Dhabi and can be available on short notice.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
